Igor Feofilaktov

Senior software engineer
Platform & Developer Productivity

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Summary

Senior software engineer with 9+ years of platform and developer-productivity work on a large-scale ads platform (CI and acceptance testing, deployment tooling and infrastructure-as-code), with an approach of making change safe, then fast: pre-merge diff tests, mandatory CI gates and zero-diff migrations. Open to platform and developer-productivity roles.

Work Experience

Yandex, Advertising technologies (Aug 2017 – Present)

Nov 2025 – Present **Senior software engineer**, *Ads runtime infrastructure team*

Deployment tooling, infrastructure-as-code and change safety for a large-scale Ads Retrieval service.

- **Go deployment-spec generator:** main contributor; took it from prototype to production (architecture, code organization, user-facing features such as Starlark extensions). Led its adoption across the Ads Retrieval service: about 60 services, 160+ deployments.
- **Change safety for the tool and its specs:**
  - **Tool developers:** pre-merge diff tests check every tool change against all user specs.
  - **Users:** diff tests out of the box; spec changes and quota impact visible on every pull request.
  - **Releases:** versioned feature flags and staged channels (testing → prestable → stable); opt-in features ship in one release cycle.
- **Infrastructure changes visible at review time:** mandatory spec diff tests in CI; all services moved to plain IaC on an in-house, Kubernetes-API-based platform (CRDs) with zero diff.
- **On-call:** release rollouts, load drills, capacity changes; incident mitigation and root-cause analysis; alerting reworked as code.

Nov 2021 – Oct 2025 **Senior software engineer**, *Ads testing & release infrastructure team*

Technical lead of a three-person team for the ad server's acceptance platform (traffic-replay diff, performance and sanitizer testing), used daily by 200+ engineers.

- **Faster feedback:** pre-merge check 5 h → 3 h with full feature coverage; A/B test data 24 h → 3 h old.
- **Time-to-production:** p90 age of the latest release-ready build cut from about 2 days to 12 h, held there by an SLO with alerting.
- **CI migration:** all pre-merge checks moved to the company-wide monorepo CI; legacy CI task SDK retired.
- **Test-harness framework:** component-based design; new microservices join acceptance tests in days, with full coverage.
- **Platform consolidation:** owned the migration plan to the shared diff and performance testing platform: a Nomad/LXC proof of concept, then parallel runs to prove parity.

Apr 2018 – Oct 2021 **Software engineer**, *QA & release infrastructure team*

Developed reliable diff tests for the Ads Engine, with test data refreshed automatically from production. Improved QA and release processes:

- Tripled releases, from 1 to 3 per week on average, by automating the acceptance process.
- Halved the minimum detectable effect (MDE) of performance diff tests, from 2% to 1%.
- Improved the stability and availability of the testing infrastructure by setting up a monitoring and alerting system.

Aug 2017 – Apr 2018 **Software engineer**, *Statistics infrastructure team*

Designed and implemented a distributed system for availability monitoring of advertisers' websites, cutting the average reaction time from 24 hours to 1 hour.

Earlier experience (2014 – 2017)

2015 – 2017 QA automation engineer in mail service teams at New Cloud Technologies (Dec 2016 – Jul 2017) and Search portal Sputnik (Sep 2015 – Nov 2016): built an automated testing framework from the ground up, integrated QA into CI/CD, and automated API, functional and regression tests.

2014 – 2015 Tech support engineer at Internet-Initiatives Development Fund: set up Zabbix monitoring for network devices and production services; automated routine data processing and website tests with Selenium.

Education

2009 – 2014 **Specialist in Mathematics (5-year degree, MSc equivalent)**, *Lomonosov Moscow State University*, Moscow, Russia

Skills

Programming	Python (advanced), Go (production), C++ (reading and debugging), SQL, Bash
Infrastructure	Infrastructure-as-code on a Kubernetes-API-based platform (CRDs), Helm/kustomize-style templating (ytt, Starlark), protobuf schemas, HashiCorp Nomad, LXC, pod autoscaling
CI/CD & testing	Monorepo CI, release automation, feature flags and staged release channels, traffic-replay diff testing, performance testing, sanitizers (ASan, TSan, MSan), pytest
Reliability	SLI/SLO design, alerting and dashboards as code, Grafana, on-call and incident management, capacity planning
Data	MapReduce-based big-data platform, distributed key-value stores
Earlier tools	Jenkins, Zabbix, Selenium, Perl

Languages

Russian	Native
English	B2 (upper intermediate)
Serbian	A2 (elementary)